The Guardian

one stop english

‘It’s a bit too castle-y’: plans to turn Cumbrian fortress into eco-attraction

Level 3: Advanced – Teacher’s notes

Article summary: The article describes a family’s initiative to turn their castle into a carbon-zero ecotourist destination.

Time: 60 minutes

Skills: Reading, Speaking, Writing

Language focus: Phrases

Materials needed: One copy of the worksheet per student

1. Warmer

a. The purpose of this activity is to get students to think about travel and their own preferences. All of these countries are considered top ecotourism destinations. Make sure learners give reasons for their choice of destination. This can be continued in the *In Your Own Words* activity, where they can use the same destination to complete the task.

2. Key words

a. Ask students to do the exercise individually and then compare their answers in pairs or small groups. Note that some words have additional meanings outside the environmental context. *Renewable* can also mean‘something that can be continued for a longer period of time,’ e.g., a *renewable contract*. *Sustainable* can also mean ‘anything that can continue for a long time at the same level,’ e.g., *sustainable economic growth*. Some other terms have additional meanings too. *Obstacle* can also be used when referring to any problem or difficulty that prevents someone from achieving something. *Boundary* is frequently used in the plural in relationships to talk about what someone will/won’t allow, e.g., ‘He wanted to be with his new girlfriend all the time, but she wanted clearer *boundaries*.’

Key:

1. *fortress*
2. *carbon-zero*
3. *renewable*
4. *sustainable*
5. *isolated*
6. *custodian*
7. *heir*
8. *drag show*
9. *obstacle*
10. *geothermal*
11. *creepiness*
12. *sanctuary*
13. *hide-and-seek*
14. *boundary*
15. *ecotourism*

b. Before reading the article carefully, students use some of the key words to fill the gaps in the sentences to ensure that they understand their meanings and usage.

1. *sustainable*
2. *obstacle*
3. *isolated*
4. *creepiness*
5. *ecotourism*

3. Comprehension check

a. The answers given are only suggested answers, and students may correctly answer the questions in different ways, e.g., in item 1, they may say, ‘The castle is in the UK’ or similar.

Key:

1. *the Lake District in northwest England*
2. *three black bears*
3. *It’s been replaced by a solar farm.*
4. *800 years old*
5. *make Muncaster the first carbon-zero castle in the UK*
6. *a drag show (Dragcaster), a sausage festival (Sausage Fest), a music festival (Krankenhaus), an obstacle race (Race the Tide), a Halloween show (Scarecaster)*
7. *from solar panels and a geothermal pump*
8. *one brother (Fraser) and one sister (Isla)*
9. *about £10,000 of annual profit*
10. *a Venetian glass bowl from Henry VI*

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4. Key language

a. Students could be asked to do this exercise individually and then compare their answers in pairs. The answers given are the phrases used in the text.

Key:

1.	*g*	*5.*	*b*
2.	*d*	*6.*	*c*
3.	*a*	*7.*	*e*
4.	*h*	*8.*	*f*

5. Discussion

a. Allow students time to note down their ideas about each statement and encourage them to say why they agree or disagree with each one.

6. In your own words

a. Divide your class in pairs, trios, or small groups. Students use a search engine to find more information about ecotourism. Ask them to find some top locations for ecotourism holidays and what you can do in those places. Students could use one of the locations from the Warmer exercise if they wish. They can set up the acitity in class and continue as homework to allow for further research.

b. Students then present their reports to the class.

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